

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 4 · The Executive Branch (GC.16–GC.18)

Match the task to the tool —
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put steps in order / show a process	● Timeline · Sequence	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. Our signature move.

Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Unit 3 · The Legislative Branch (SSP.01) Unit 2 · Citizen Participation (SSP.01–SSP.06)

Every organizer doubles as a skills tool.

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 4 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)	ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT	WHERE IN UNIT 4
● SSP.01	Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.	5 Ws · Main Idea & Details · K-W-L	GC.17 departments (Matrix); K-W-L to open the unit.
● SSP.02	Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias.	HIPPO · C-E-R	GC.16 Article II powers (HIPPO / source analysis of the oath & clauses).
● SSP.03	Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.	Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn	GC.17 executive departments (Matrix, department × duty).
● SSP.04	Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.	C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution	GC.18 Electoral College for/against (T-Chart); C-E-R on executive power.
● SSP.05	Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.	Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence	GC.16 checks on the President (how each power is limited over time).
● SSP.06	Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.	Tennessee Connection · Matrix	Limited in Foundations; primary geographic focus lands in Unit 7 (TN State & Local). Use the ★ Tennessee Connection to bridge.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Two

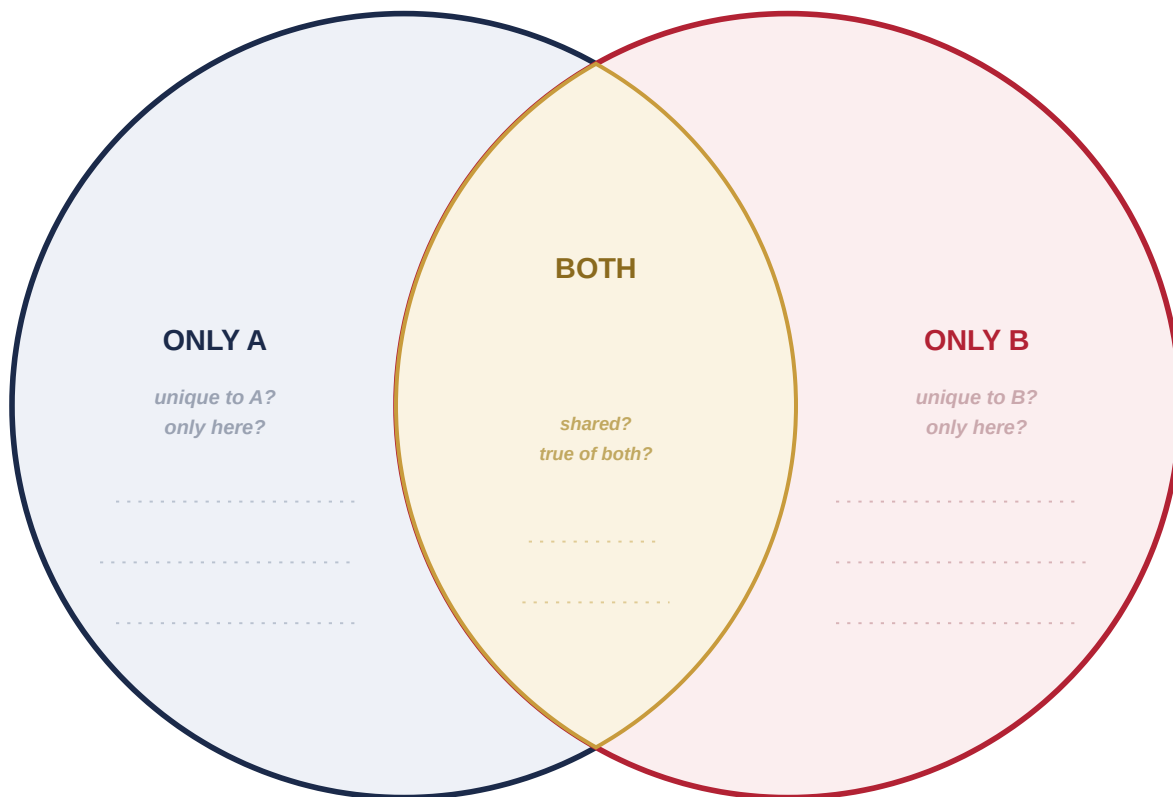
Marzano #1

WHEN · WHY Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

Topic A: _____
write in the left circle

Topic B: _____
write in the right circle



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

WHEN · WHY Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.
Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

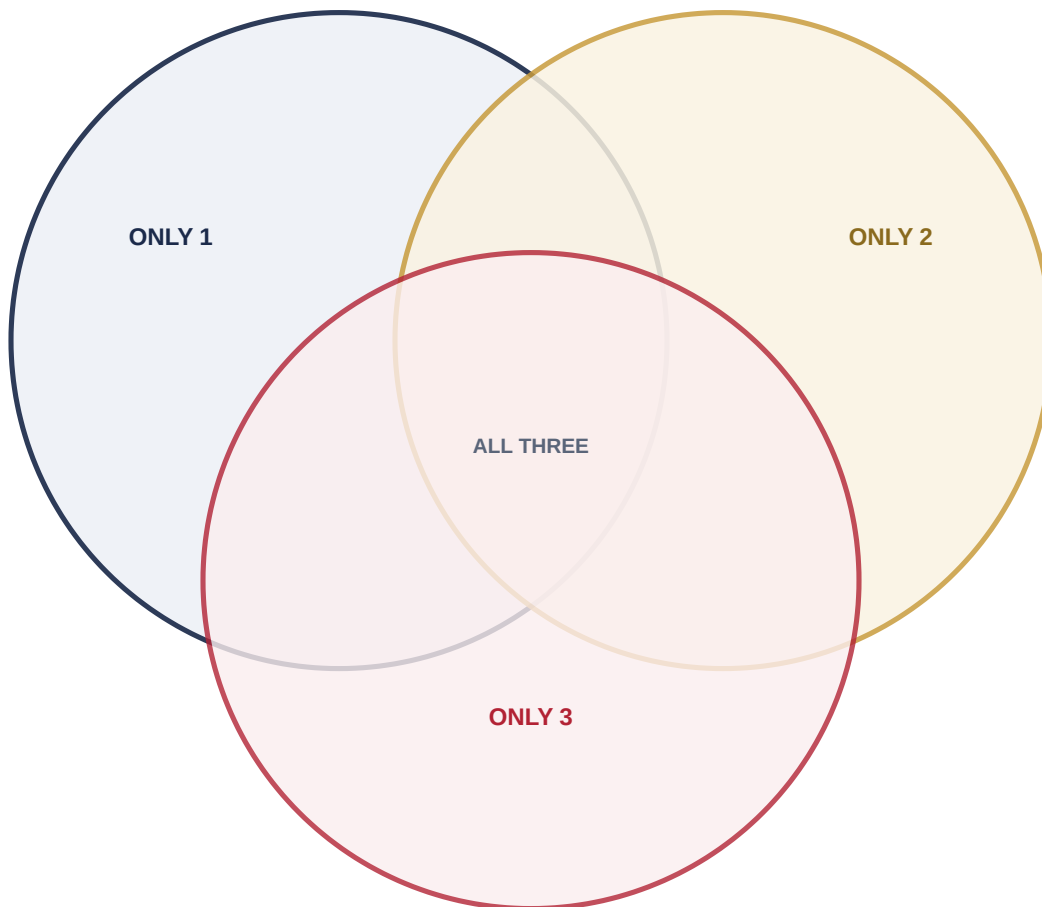
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

EXTEND

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.

SIDE B

label this column

Point 2 add your evidence

[illegible]This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

Weigh it: Based on both columns, what do you conclude? _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

Fill one strong point on each side together, then students add two more per side.

Write a one-paragraph judgment that uses evidence from **both** columns.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

	Case 1 name it	Case 2 name it	Case 3 name it
Criterion A			
Criterion B			
Criterion C			
PATTERN		What pattern do you see across the cases?	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

EXTEND
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

SSP.05

WHEN · WHY Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

List what led up to the event on the left; list what it set in motion on the right.

CAUSES

WHAT CONDITIONS MADE IT HAPPEN?

EFFECTS

WHAT DID IT LEAD TO?

THE EVENT
name it

So what? Which single cause mattered most, and why?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

EXTEND

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

WHEN · WHY Put events in **order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

Event 2 — what happened?

Event 3 — what happened?

Event 4 — why did it matter?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Concept Web

⌚ 10-15 min

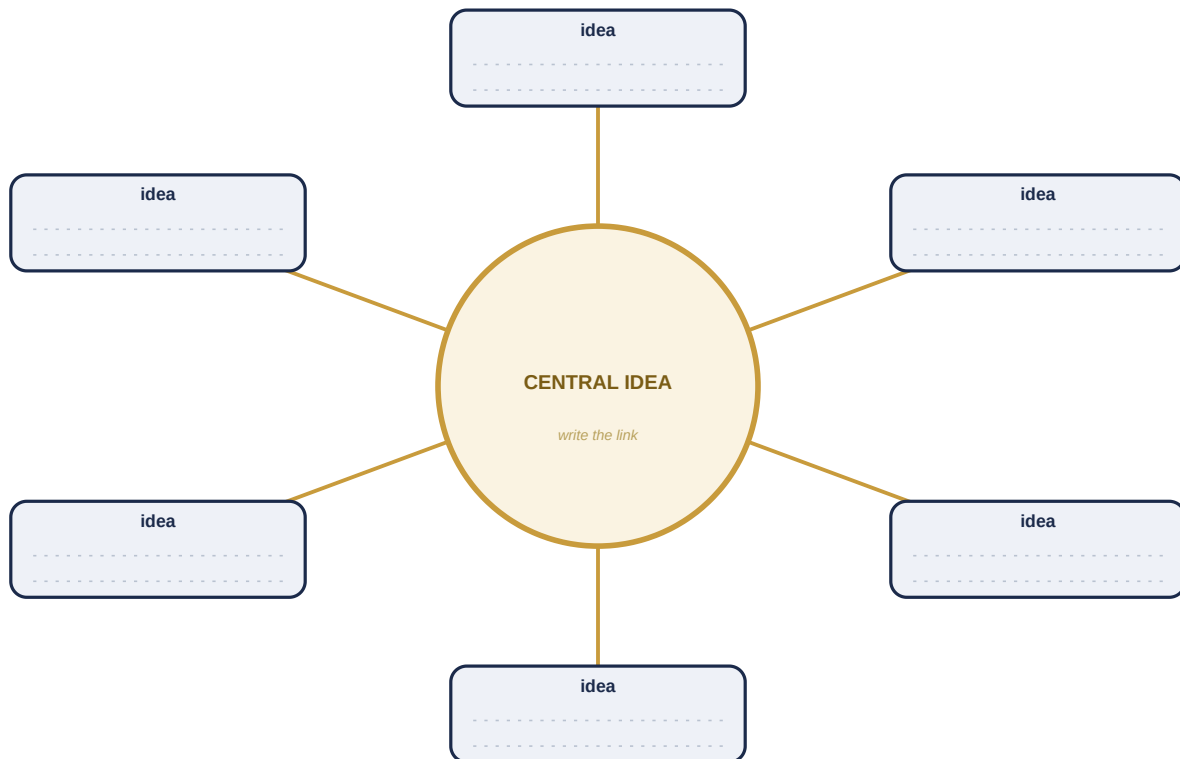
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web

Schema

WHEN · WHY **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.

**MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT** UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

EXTEND

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Summarize by separating the big idea from the details that support it. *Distinguishing central idea from detail is core disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

In one sentence: the main idea matters because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Fill K and W before you start; return to L after the lesson.

[illegible]

UDL · MTSS

Offer sentence starters: 'I already know...', 'I want to know...', 'I learned...'.

In the L column, note one thing you still wonder — a question for further inquiry.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

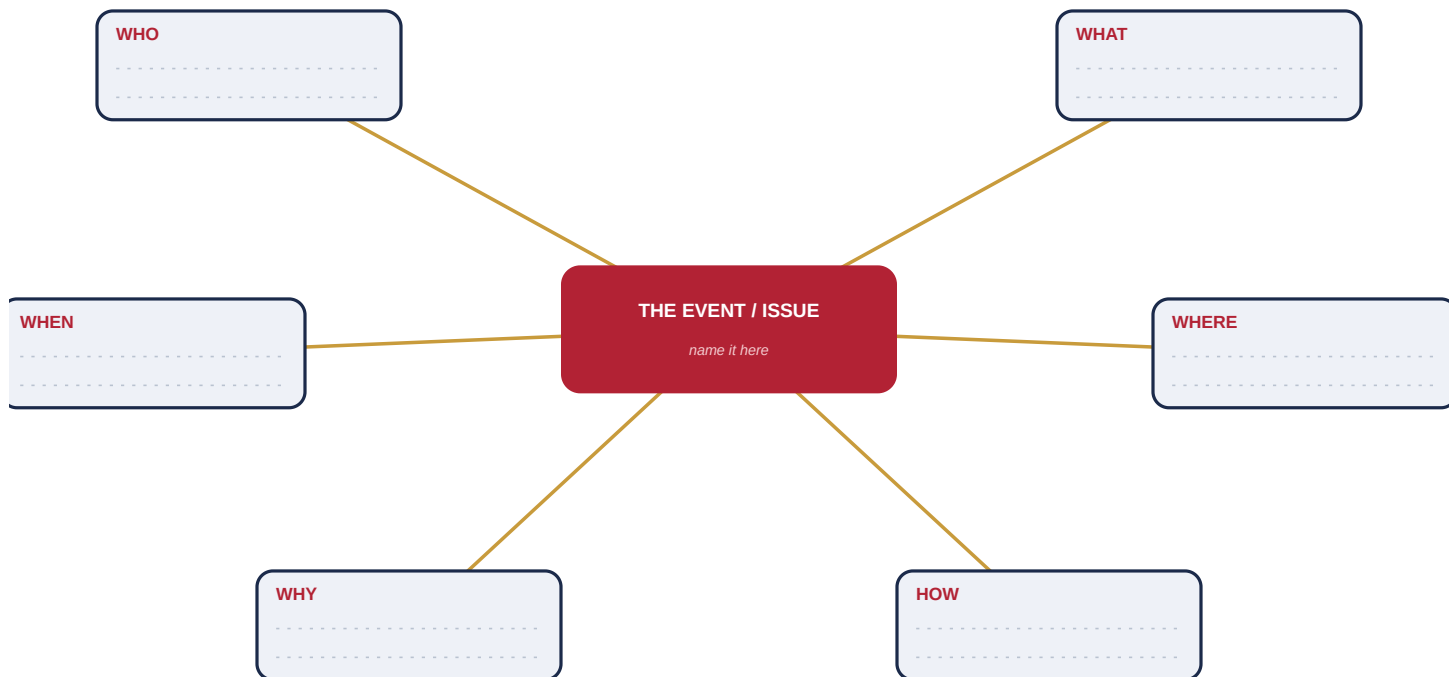
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

5 Ws

SSP.01

WHEN · WHY Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Problem-Solution

Decision

WHEN · WHY Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Option B: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Best solution: _____ — because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

DEFINITION (in your words)	CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)
TERM write the term	
EXAMPLES	EXAMPLES

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

EXTEND
Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

WHEN · WHY Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.
Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?
MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

EXTEND

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

HIPPO

SSP.02

WHEN · WHY Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: _____ title · author / creator · date · type

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

P

POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

P

PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Signature Move

Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.

[illegible]

How are they linked? _____

Why the local story matters: _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.

Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to *and* different from the national one.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

The Many Hats of the President

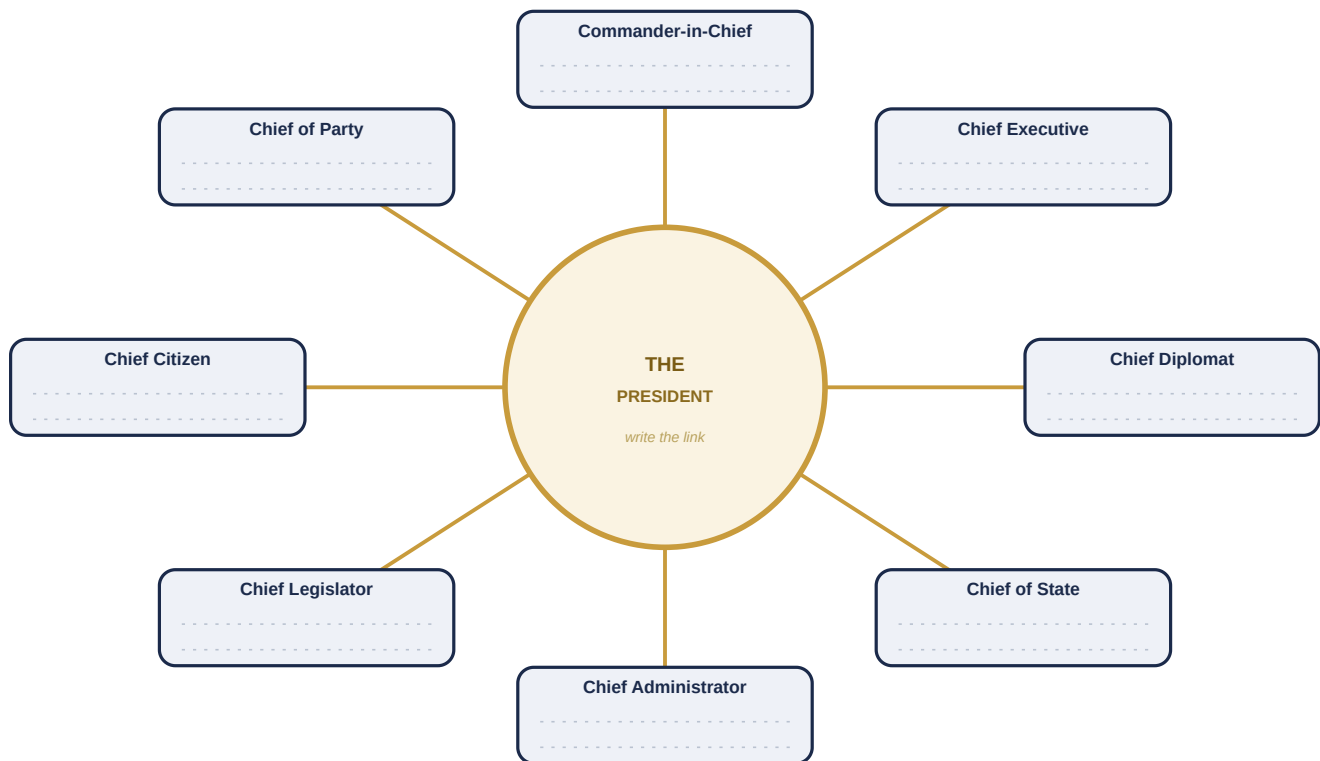
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web • Connect Roles

DOK 2 • Organize

WHEN • WHY Article II packs many jobs into one office. A concept web gathers the President's roles around a single hub, so students see how much — and how many kinds of — power the office holds. *Organizing ideas around a hub builds schema (SSP.01).*

In each bubble, name what the President does in that role — and one check on it.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Match three roles to real actions together (e.g., Commander-in-Chief → directs the military) before students finish.

EXTEND

For two roles, name the constitutional check that limits the President's power in that role.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY The President cannot execute the law alone. A matrix lines up the major departments against the same questions so students can see who does what. *Holding cases to one yardstick is Marzano’s highest-yield strategy.*

For each department, name what it does and a real problem it would handle.

	STATE foreign policy	TREASURY money	DEFENSE military
What it does			
A problem it handles			
PATTERN		Add two more: Justice and Education — what does each do? _____	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENTUDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Pre-fill the State column together; students complete Treasury and Defense, then add Justice & Education.

EXTEND
Explain the 'iron triangle' among a department, a congressional committee, and interest groups.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

The Electoral College — For & Against

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

T-Chart · Weigh Two Sides

SSP.04 · DOK 3

WHEN · WHY The standard asks students to weigh the Electoral College, not just describe it. A T-chart forces evidence on both sides before a verdict — exactly the argument the country keeps having. *Constructing arguments from both sides builds TN Practice SSP.04.*

Gather the strongest evidence for each side, then decide.

ARGUMENTS FOR
keep the Electoral College

Protects smaller states how does it give small states a voice?

Forces national campaigns why campaign in many states, not just big cities?

Federalism how does it fit a system of states?

ARGUMENTS AGAINST
reform or replace it

Popular vote can lose why is a popular-vote/electoral split a problem?

Swing states dominate why do a few states get most attention?

One person, one vote? does every vote count equally?

Your verdict: Keep, reform, or replace the Electoral College — **because** _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Sort a set of claim cards into FOR and AGAINST before writing.

EXTEND
Honors: research one reform (direct election, proportional allocation, the National Popular Vote compact) and evaluate it.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.